IT Incident Response Handbook

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1. Purpose

This handbook defines the fictional response process used when a Northstar technology service is degraded, unavailable, or affected by a security event.

2. Priority matrix

Priority	Typical impact	Acknowledge	Update cadence
P1 Critical	Widespread outage, safety impact, or severe security event	15 minutes	Every 30 minutes
P2 High	Major degradation; no practical workaround	30 minutes	Every 60 minutes
P3 Medium	Limited impact; workaround available	4 business hours	Daily or on material change
P4 Low	Information or standard request	1 business day	As agreed

3. P1 declaration and first 15 minutes

- Call emergency extension 7788 and open a Nova incident record.
- State the affected service, observed impact, start time, and any suspected security involvement.
- The Major Incident Manager opens the bridge, assigns an Incident Commander, and names a technical lead.
- Preserve logs and evidence. Do not restart systems merely to clear symptoms unless authorized by the technical lead.

4. Incident roles

Role	Primary responsibility
Incident Commander	Owns decisions, priorities, and overall coordination
Technical Lead	Directs diagnosis, mitigation, and technical recovery
Communications Lead	Issues approved employee and customer updates
Scribe	Maintains the event timeline, decisions, and action log
Security Lead	Leads containment and evidence handling when security is involved

5. Required update format

Each update should include confirmed impact, current mitigation, known risk, decisions required, owner of the next action, and the time of the next update. For a P1, updates are issued every 30 minutes even when there is no material change.

6. Recovery and closure

Service restoration must be verified through monitoring and a business-owner check. The Incident Commander approves closure. A preliminary summary is created within one business day, and a formal root-cause analysis is completed within five business days for qualifying P1 events.

7. Evidence checklist

- Timeline of alerts, calls, changes, and decisions
- Relevant application, infrastructure, identity, and security logs
- Customer and employee communications
- Recovery validation results and remaining risks

This document is fictional and intended only for RAG ingestion and evaluation practice.